

Impact Studio in Collaboration with MUV
Sciences Po

Exploring market entry conditions, for *MUV* in France

Authors: Emmanuel LANDAU, Valentine RIEHL, Angelina SAKHARUK, Melina Pilar SEQUEIRA TERUEL
Supervised by Sophie Le Mouel Picone

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- **Our context, background**

In the face of the climate emergency and the urgent need to reduce transport-related emissions, everyday mobility has become a key lever for transformation. Across Europe, public policies are increasingly encouraging more sustainable practices through the development of cycling infrastructure, financial incentives, and regulatory obligations for companies.

However, a persistent gap remains between these structural ambitions and actual user behaviour. While the conditions for sustainable mobility are improving, adoption remains uneven and often short-lived. This highlights a key limitation of current approaches: infrastructure alone is not sufficient to drive lasting behavioural change.

It is within this context that MUV operates. MUV is an Italian startup that develops a gamified application designed to encourage more sustainable mobility behaviours. By transforming daily movements into playful and collective experiences, MUV seeks to act directly on individual motivations and social dynamics.

As part of the Impact Studio at Sciences Po, our team was tasked with supporting MUV in a critical strategic phase: assessing the conditions for deploying its solution in the French market, taking into account regulatory, institutional, and cultural specificities.

- **Objectives of our project**

This project approached design from an evaluation perspective, assessing how an existing solution could fit into a new ecosystem.

The main objective was therefore:

to understand under which conditions a gamified mobility solution can be adopted, deployed, and sustained in France.

This work is grounded in a multi-level impact perspective:

- Environmental impact: encouraging more sustainable mobility practices and reducing emissions from daily travel
- Behavioural impact: fostering long-term habit change beyond short-term awareness campaigns
- Institutional impact: supporting public and private actors in achieving their objectives (CSR, carbon reporting, mobility policies)

How can a solution like MUV integrate into a highly institutionalised mobility ecosystem while generating meaningful and sustained user engagement?

To address this problematic, we explored several key questions:

What are the barriers and drivers for adopting a gamified mobility solution in France?

How is the ecosystem of public actors, private stakeholders, and users structured?

Why do existing initiatives struggle to generate long-term behavioural change?

What strategic positioning would allow MUV to create value within this ecosystem?

- **Methodology**

To address the complexity of the topic, we adopted a qualitative and systemic approach, combining several complementary methods.

Internal analysis of MUV

We first conducted an in-depth analysis of MUV's model, including its value proposition, engagement mechanisms, and positioning at the intersection of technological innovation and behavioural design.

We also carried out a user experience analysis to identify friction points in everyday use (tracking, onboarding, engagement).

Analysis of the French ecosystem

We then mapped the French sustainable mobility environment, including regulatory frameworks (mobility, data protection, CSR), institutional actors (local authorities, mobility agencies), existing solutions (apps, platforms, incentive mechanisms).

This analysis revealed a dense yet fragmented ecosystem structured around actors with different logics and priorities.

Field research and interviews

We conducted interviews with a range of stakeholders institutional actors (local governments, regional networks), mobility experts, potential partners

These discussions allowed us to test our hypotheses against real-world practices, particularly in terms of governance and decision-making processes.

Territorial analysis

Finally, we identified priority territories for potential deployment, based on criteria such as: political commitment to sustainable mobility, governance structure, local mobility culture and partnership opportunities.

● **Findings and Analysis**

The French mobility market is highly institutionalised, with local authorities and mobility agencies playing a central role in shaping and implementing policies.

However, this structure is accompanied by strong fragmentation. On one side, infrastructure and technical solutions (transport systems, MaaS, funding mechanisms). And, on the other side, engagement tools that are often temporary (challenges, campaigns)

A gap : between policy and practice

A key insight emerges between mobility policies that are driven by institutional objectives, while behaviour change depends on individuals. Yet users are rarely involved in the design

of these systems, leading to low ownership, limited continuity in usage and reliance on short-term incentives

Gamification, an underutilised lever

While gamification-based solutions exist, their long-term impact remains limited. Our analysis shows that gamification is often used as a short-term activation tool. It is rarely embedded in long-term behavioural strategies and it is insufficiently connected to real everyday practices

Concrete usage barriers

The analysis of MUV highlighted that barriers are not only strategic but also operational. Complexity of tracking, lack of clarity during onboarding, limited visibility of engagement in daily life : these issues reduce the app's ability to integrate into users' routines.

Despite these limitations, MUV holds strong strategic potential. Our analysis reveals a critical gap in the ecosystem between infrastructures (which enable) and behaviours (which decide)

Operational Recommendations and Perspectives

To generate impact, MUV must reduce friction and integrate into daily routines, for instance by automate tracking as much as possible, simplify the user experience and provide immediate feedback on actions

Integrate into existing ecosystems ?

Rather than operating as a standalone application, MUV should integrate with existing platforms, collaborate with institutional actors and align with existing mobility programmes.

Engagement is stronger when it is collective and contextualised :

How to activate local collective dynamics ?

This can be achieved by designing challenges linked to local events, mobilising existing communities (companies, institutions, clubs) and reinforcing territorial anchoring

Conclusion

This research highlights a central paradox, while sustainable mobility policies are becoming increasingly structured and ambitious, their impact remains limited by the lack of tools capable of engaging individuals over time.

Within this gap, MUV holds a strong strategic opportunity to act as an intermediary between systems and behaviours, bridging institutional objectives and lived experiences.

However, this opportunity depends on a key shift moving from a standalone application logic to an integration-driven approach, embedded within local ecosystems and everyday

practices. More than a technological tool, MUV has the potential to become a driver of behavioural transformation, provided it successfully combines engagement, simplicity, and territorial relevance.